

Japan Healthcare: Medical Devices: China business climate for Medtech: Global company views from results briefings

We summarize comments from global medtech companies at their Jan-Mar 2026 results briefings regarding changes in the business environment in China. While the China businesses of medtech stocks are showing signs of recovery/bottoming out of impacts in some areas, the risk of a prolonged/worsening impact from healthcare cost-control policies remains, particularly in the in-vitro diagnostics (IVD) sector.

Regarding the China businesses of Japanese companies, we are particularly focused on progress in discussions on unifying test prices at **Sysmex** ([link](#)) and the contribution of locally manufactured products at **Olympus**.

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Key points from medtech company comments

In China, while healthcare cost-control and Buy-China policies remain concerns, there is a mix of companies seeing a continued negative impact and those showing signs of recovery or seeing the impact of these policies bottoming out. This owes partly to differences in business portfolios.

Below, we outline key highlights from companies' commentary at their results briefings. We compiled commentary from Japanese companies and overseas companies relevant in terms of implications for our coverage.

Japan

Olympus (7733.T, May 12)

The business environment in China remains challenging, and 4Q sales for the Gastrointestinal Solutions (GIS) business in China were down 19% yoy (1Q: -16%, 2Q: -15%, 3Q: +6%). Olympus expects a recovery in FY3/27, partly due to growth for products manufactured locally in China. The three-year management strategy (FY3/27-FY3/29) aims for low- to mid-single-digit (%) growth for the China business.

For our views on FY3/26 results, see the report at this [link](#).

Sysmex (6869.T, May 14)

In its China business, Sysmex is affected by healthcare cost-control policies and distributor inventory adjustments (mainly for reagents), and 4Q sales dropped a sharp 38.5% yoy. FY3/27 guidance incorporates the possibility of unified test pricing

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being newly introduced, in addition to existing impacts from the minimum necessary principle, distributor inventory adjustments, and volume-based procurement (VBP). Sysmex sees uncertainty as to when and how the new pricing policy is implemented, and thinks it could be a source of earnings volatility. Medium- to long-term testing demand in China remains robust, and as the country looks to shift to a more sustainable healthcare system, the company believes the value of its testing solutions will be re-recognized. It plans to strengthen this business, including through a shift to direct sales.

For our views on FY3/26 results, see the report at this [link](#).

Terumo (4543.T, May 15)

In China, Terumo said VBP in the Neurovascular business of the C&V segment has led to a volume increase through sales channel expansion that has more than offset price declines.

For our views on FY3/26 results, see the report at this [link](#).

Asahi Intecc (7747.T, May 15, Not Covered)

The company thinks impact of guidewire price declines due to healthcare cost-control policies has largely run its course, except in Shanghai. The impact is also becoming apparent for products other than guidewires, but is generally within the company's assumptions. Mortality from cardiovascular diseases remains high in China, and the management expects an increase in volume to accompany the decline in unit prices.

US and Europe

Johnson & Johnson (JNJ, April 14, covered by Asad Haider)

JNJ management sees further VBP headwinds in China, expecting them to be more prominent in 2H26 than 1H. 1Q sales in the Surgery segment grew 1.2% yoy, with negative impacts from VBP partially offsetting other growth. In 2H2026, JNJ expects VBP impact in Electrophysiology (EP) products as well.

For GS views on 1Q results, see the report at this [link](#).

Abbott Laboratories (ABT, April 16, covered by David Roman)

ABT views its flat yoy sales in China for the Core Lab business in 1Q as positive progress, considering the 15-30% yoy decline in sales every quarter in 2025. While the company cannot say for sure that the headwinds in the China market are over, its 1Q sales momentum was ahead of guidance for a single-digit (%) decline for the full year. ABT noted that about 80% of its China business portfolio is subject to VBP, and its share is limited in areas that could be newly targeted by the policy (fertility and cancer).

For GS views on 1Q results, see the report at this [link](#).

Boston Scientific Corp. (BSX, April 22, covered by David Roman)

BSX noted that China delivered strong double-digit sales growth while overcoming headwinds from VBP. VBP impacted the Urology unit's Stone Management (MedSurg) business and its Arterial business (Cardiovascular). VBP impact on the Arterial business

in China is expected to taper off in the second quarter.

For GS views on 1Q results, see the report at this [link](#).

Roche (ROPC.S, April 23, covered by James Quigley)

The Diagnostics business continues to be affected by healthcare cost-control policies in China, and sales in the region declined 14% yoy. Sales for the entire diagnostics business grew 3% yoy, but 5% excluding China. Within this, the Core Lab business sales increased 4%, and 8% excluding China. The impact of healthcare cost-control policies is expected to ease over 2026.

For GS views on 1Q results, see the report at this [link](#).

Revvity Inc. (RVTY, May 5, covered by Evie Koslosky)

RVTY will divest its Immunodiagnostics business in China (equivalent to about 6% of total company sales) to concentrate resources in more profitable areas. Behind the divestment are continued headwinds in the diagnostics market, such as price pressure and changes in demand, reflecting impact from China's healthcare cost-control policies. The company will continue to focus on the life sciences business, which is expected to see strong market growth in China, and the reproductive health business, for which localization has been established.

For GS views on 1Q results, see the report at this [link](#).

China

Mindray (300760.SZ, April 28, covered by Tianyi Yan)

Reflecting funding constraints in IVD business in China, attempts are being made to control reagent prices and usage through various means. In this environment, there is also an accelerating trend of domestic products replacing imported ones at Tier-3 hospitals. The company has set a goal of tapping into high-end customers from 1H2025, aiming to expand its market share in immunoassay, biochemistry, and coagulation from 10% to 20% within three years. The company is making steady progress toward its goal, with its share rising to 13% as of 1Q.

For GS views on 1Q results, see the report at this [link](#).

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Sysmex

We are Buy rated. Our 12-month target price of ¥1,700 is based on the global medtech sector's FY3/28E EV/EBITDA average of 11.0X, to which we apply a 20% discount. Key downside risks include geopolitical risks and supply chain changes, healthcare system reforms including cost-containment policies globally, heightened competition (particularly the emergence of local makers in emerging markets and the subsequent risk of price declines), forex trends, greater inflationary pressures, and weaker capex trends.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Olympus

We are Buy-rated. Our 12-month target price of ¥2,050 is based on a 10% discount applied to the global medtech sector average FY3/28E EV/EBITDA of 11.0X. Key risks

include regulatory changes in global markets, changes in the business environment in the China medtech market, risks associated with the spread of infectious diseases, greater-than-expected yen appreciation, inflation impacts, risks related to manufacturing/sales activities, risks associated with development, major changes in the competitive environment, and risks associated with growth investment.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Terumo

We are Neutral rated. Our 12-month target price of ¥2,400 is based on a FY3/28E EV/EBITDA multiple of 11.0X, derived from the global medtech sector average. Key risks include more drastic healthcare cost-cutting measures than expected, deviation in core product sales due to competition and changing needs of medical care providers, manufacturing and quality issues, the number of procedures being affected by a shortage of personnel at medical facilities, inflation impact, and greater-than-expected yen appreciation/depreciation.

Disclosure Appendix

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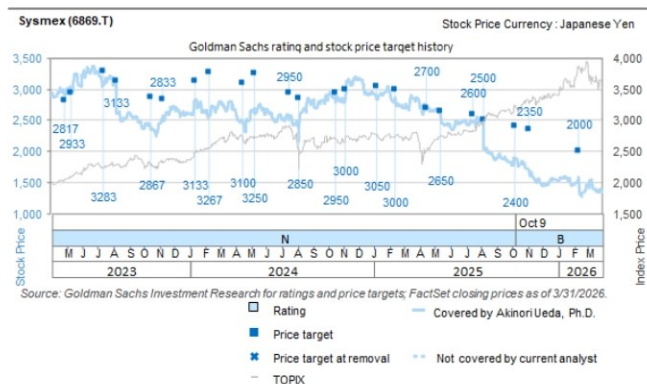
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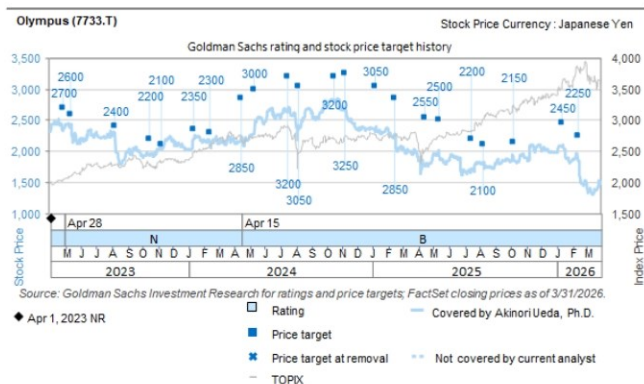
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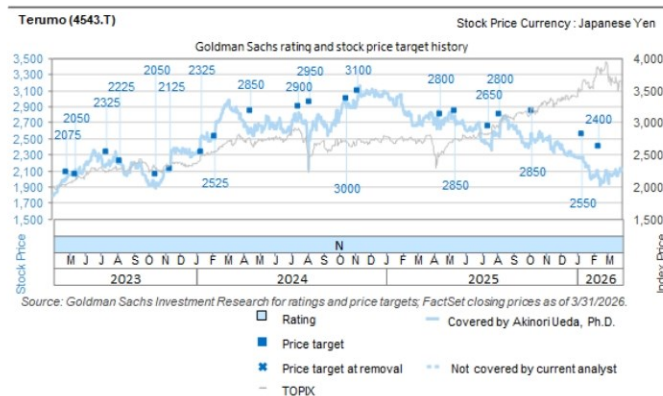
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Target price history table(s)

Terumo (4543.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
13-Feb-26	2,400	2,011
13-Jan-26	2,550	2,270
09-Oct-25	2,850	2,507
07-Aug-25	2,800	2,530
17-Jul-25	2,650	2,447
14-May-25	2,850	2,727
15-Apr-25	2,800	2,713
07-Nov-24	3,100	2,980
16-Oct-24	3,000	2,919
08-Aug-24	2,950	2,486
17-Jul-24	2,900	2,827
15-Apr-24	2,850	2,588
07-Feb-24	5,050	2,537
12-Jan-24	4,650	2,534
14-Nov-23	4,250	2,123
17-Oct-23	4,100	1,958
09-Aug-23	4,450	2,213

Sysmex (6869.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
14-May-26	1,700	1,343
14-Apr-26	1,850	1,397
12-Feb-26	2,000	1,584
05-Nov-25	2,350	1,707
09-Oct-25	2,400	1,869
06-Aug-25	2,500	2,495
17-Jul-25	2,600	2,490
14-May-25	2,650	2,637
15-Apr-25	2,700	2,719
12-Feb-25	3,000	2,864
07-Jan-25	3,050	2,843
06-Nov-24	3,000	2,849
16-Oct-24	2,950	2,822
06-Aug-24	2,850	2,389
17-Jul-24	2,950	2,509
09-May-24	3,250	2,704
15-Apr-24	3,100	2,448

Terumo (4543.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
13-Jul-23	4,650	2,189

Sysmex (6869.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
09-Feb-24	9,800	2,571
12-Jan-24	9,400	2,837
08-Nov-23	8,500	2,499
17-Oct-23	8,600	2,382
08-Aug-23	9,400	3,085
13-Jul-23	9,850	3,117

Olympus (7733.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
12-May-26	2,050	1,541
14-Apr-26	1,950	1,585
13-Feb-26	2,250	1,853
13-Jan-26	2,450	2,072
09-Oct-25	2,150	1,879
08-Aug-25	2,100	1,825
17-Jul-25	2,200	1,719
13-May-25	2,500	2,017
15-Apr-25	2,550	1,794
14-Feb-25	2,850	2,275
07-Jan-25	3,050	2,344
08-Nov-24	3,250	2,660
16-Oct-24	3,200	2,801
07-Aug-24	3,050	2,424
17-Jul-24	3,200	2,683
11-May-24	3,000	2,289
15-Apr-24	2,850	2,189
14-Feb-24	2,300	2,100
12-Jan-24	2,350	2,217
09-Nov-23	2,100	2,086
17-Oct-23	2,200	1,953
09-Aug-23	2,400	2,251

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